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SEDEMAC

SEDEMAC MECHATRONICS LIMITED
(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)



(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus)

Our Company was incorporated as 'SEDEMAC Mechatronics Private Limited' as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to the certificate of incorporation dated July 18, 2007, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Mumbai. Further, our Company was converted into a public limited company pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board of Directors in their meeting held on April 29, 2024 and by our Shareholders pursuant to their resolution passed in an Extraordinary General Meeting held on June 7, 2024, upon which the name of our Company was changed to 'SEDEMAC Mechatronics Limited' and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated September 2, 2024 pursuant to such change of name was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre. For details in relation to changes in the name and registered office of our Company, see "*History and Certain Corporate Matters – Brief history of our Company*" and "*History and Certain Corporate Matters - Changes in the registered office*" on page 280 of the red herring prospectus dated February 25, 2026 ("RHP" or "Red Herring Prospectus") filed with the RoC.

Registered and Corporate Office: Survey No. 270/1/A/2, Pallod Farms, Baner Road, Baner, Baner Gaon, Haveli, Pune - 411 045, Maharashtra, India, Tel: +91 20 6715 7200; Website: www.sedemac.com; Contact person: Prasad Rajendra Chavan, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; Email: cs@sedemac.com, Corporate Identity Number: U29253PN2007PLC246956

THE PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY: PROF. SHASHIKANTH SURYANARAYANAN, AMIT ARUN DIXIT, MANISH SHARMA AND ANAYKUMAR AVINASH JOSHI

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 8,043,300 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF SEDEMAC MECHATRONICS LIMITED ("COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [•] MILLION THROUGH AN OFFER FOR SALE OF, IN AGGREGATE, UP TO 8,043,300 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [•] MILLION, COMPRISING OF UP TO 45,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION BY PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER (AS DEFINED HEREINAFTER), UP TO 67,500 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION BY PROMOTER GROUP SELLING SHAREHOLDER (AS DEFINED HEREINAFTER), UP TO 7,830,800 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION BY INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDERS (AS DEFINED HEREINAFTER) COLLECTIVELY THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND SUCH EQUITY SHARES OFFERED BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFER FOR SALE", AND SUCH INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING, THE "OFFER". THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH (CONSTITUTING UP TO [•]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY) AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 10.00 MILLION FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (AS DEFINED HEREINAFTER) (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). OUR COMPANY IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS, MAY OFFER A DISCOUNT OF UP TO [•]% (EQUIVALENT OF ₹ 128 PER EQUITY SHARE) TO THE OFFER PRICE TO THE ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING UNDER THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER WILL CONSTITUTE [•]% AND [•]% OF OUR POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL, RESPECTIVELY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE			
NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS**	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH OFFERED	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION (IN ₹ PER EQUITY SHARE) [†]
Manish Sharma	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 45,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	46.00
Ashwini Amit Dixit	Promoter Group Selling Shareholder	Up to 67,500 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	100.00
A91 Emerging Fund II LLP	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 2,410,650 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	368.28
NRJN Family Trust (represented by Entrust Family Office Legal & Trusteeship Services Private Limited)	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 1,050,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	94.86
Xponentia Opportunities Fund II	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 1,043,550 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	352.29
Mace Private Limited	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 765,900 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	352.29
360 One Special Opportunities Fund – Series 8	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 680,850 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	386.31
360 One Monopolistic Market Intermediaries Fund	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 472,500 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	386.13
HDFC Life Insurance Company Limited	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 425,700 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	373.68
Xponentia Opportunities Limited	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 425,250 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹ [•] million	352.29

#As certified by S K Patodia & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants, by way of their certificate dated February 25, 2026.
**For the complete list of the Selling Shareholders and their respective weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Shares, see "*Summary of the Offer Document – Average cost of acquisition of Equity Shares of our Promoters and Selling Shareholders*" on page 24 of the RHP

PRICE BAND: ₹1,287 TO ₹1,352 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE AND THE CAP PRICE ARE 128.7 TIMES AND 135.2 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES, RESPECTIVELY.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 11 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 11 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH THEREAFTER.
A DISCOUNT OF ₹128 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (P/E) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2025 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS AS HIGH AS 124.95 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 118.95 TIMES.
P/E RATIO OF AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP AS OF FEBRUARY 20, 2026 IS 58.14.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 10.56%.

The details of the Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of our Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹1,287		At Cap Price of ₹1,352	
	Up to number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Offer for Sale	80,43,300	10,350.62	80,43,300	10,873.50
Total Offer Size	80,43,300	10,350.62	80,43,300	10,873.50
Post-Offer market capitalization of the Company	4,41,61,500	56,835.85	4,41,61,500	59,706.35

*Offer Size has been calculated considering the discount of ₹128 each at Cap Price and Lower Price for shares reserved under Employee Reservation portion.

BID/OFFER PERIOD

BID/OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON : FRIDAY, MARCH 6, 2026*

*The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date.

WE DESIGN AND SUPPLY CRITICAL, CONTROL-INTENSIVE ELECTRONIC CONTROL UNITS TO MAJOR VEHICLE AND INDUSTRIAL EQUIPMENT MANUFACTURERS IN INDIA, THE UNITED STATES AND EUROPE. OUR MAIN PRODUCTS USE INNOVATIVE, IN-HOUSE TECHNOLOGIES AND ARE ESSENTIAL FOR EQUIPMENT TO WORK SUCH AS ECUs FOR VEHICLES AND GENERATORS.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER
EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹10.00 MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BRLMS

In accordance with the recommendation of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated February 25, 2026, the above provided price band is justified based on quantitative factors/ KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Offer Price' section on page 143 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transaction(s), as applicable, disclosed in 'Basis for Offer Price' section on page 143 of the RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 33 of the RHP

1. **Customer Concentration Risk:** Customer concentration risk is a natural consequence of the "Broader Market Adoption Stage" in our business journey. During this phase, rapid market expansion for new propositions, such as our SLC-based ISG for the 2/3W industry, often relies on our relationships with our anchor customers who are early adopters. TVS Motor is our most significant customer, having adopted our SLC-based ISG proposition since 2018 and contributed 75.48%, 80.46%, 83.46% and 79.05% of our revenue from operations for the nine months ended December 31, 2025, Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively, exposing us to significant business risk if demand from these customers reduces or commercial relationships change could have a negative effect on the Company's business, profitability, and cash flows.

2. **Mobility Segment Concentration Risk:** We are significantly dependent on the mobility segment which contributed 84.63%, 85.69%, 85.64% and 80.37% of our revenue from operations for the nine months ended December 31, 2025, and Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively. Any downturn, cyclical fluctuation, or adverse development in this segment could materially impact our business, results of operations, and financial condition.

3. **Geographical Risk:** We are currently dependent on two manufacturing facilities in Pune, Maharashtra, for all the production requirements which exposes us to regional and operational risks that could have a material adverse effect on the business, results of operations, cash flows, and financial condition.

4. **Product development and lifecycle risk:** We are exposed to evolving, stage-specific, and proposition-specific risks which may materially and adversely affect the operations, financial condition, and prospects. The risk profile of the business is therefore dynamic, shifting according to the mix of products at different stages and their relative strategic and revenue importance.

5. **Industrial Segment Concentration Risk:** Our Company's results are affected by demand for gensets in India and globally, i.e., the industrial segment, which contributed 15.37%, 14.31%, 14.36% and 19.63% of our revenue from operations for the nine months ended December 31, 2025, and Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively. As a result, our operations remain closely tied to the ongoing relevance and adoption of gensets across industries. Any significant reduction in genset demand whether due to faster adoption of alternative power solutions, further tightening of regulatory standards, or decreasing customer preference for genset could materially and adversely affect our revenue, business performance, and financial stability.

6. **Trade Receivables Risk:** We are exposed to counterparty credit risk. As at December 31, 2025, March 31, 2025, 2024 and 2023, trade receivables from our top 10 customers were ₹1,384.06 million, ₹412.01 million, ₹257.12 million, and ₹131.19 million, respectively. Any delay in receiving payments or non-receipt of payments may adversely impact the business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

7. **Supplier Risk:** We are significantly dependent on the top 10 suppliers for primary raw materials, wherein purchases from top 10 suppliers constituted 63.63%, 63.64%, 65.63% and 63.34% of Company's total purchases during the nine months ended December 31, 2025, and Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively. Any disruption, delay, or inability of these suppliers to fulfil their commitments may materially and adversely affect the production, financial performance, reputation and growth prospects.

8. **Critical Raw Material Sourcing Risk:** Our Company imports critical raw materials such as semiconductors and printed circuit boards from People's Republic of China ("China"), which exposes to heightened supply chain and geopolitical risks that may materially affect the costs, production schedules, and business continuity and thereby the business, results of operations, cash flows, and future growth prospects.

9. **Offer related risk:** The Offer is 100% Offer for Sale of Equity Shares and the Selling Shareholders shall be entitled to the net proceeds from the Offer for Sale, which comprise proceeds from the Offer for Sale net of Offer expenses, to the extent of their respective portion of the Offered Shares and our Company will not receive any proceeds from the Offer.

10. **Audit qualification and statutory compliance risk:** Our Statutory Auditors' audit reports for Fiscals 2025 and 2024 and the examination report to the Restated Financial Information have included certain observations on matters specified in the Companies (Audit and Auditors) Rules, 2014 and Companies Auditor's Report Order, 2020, including limitations in our audit trail functionality and delays in tax deposits. If similar modifications and comments are included in the Statutory Auditors' reports for our financial statements in the future, it could adversely affect our financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.
11. **Compliance Risk:** Certain of our corporate records are not traceable. We cannot assure you that any regulatory proceedings or actions will not be initiated against us in the future and we will not be subject to any penalty imposed by the competent regulatory authority in this regard.

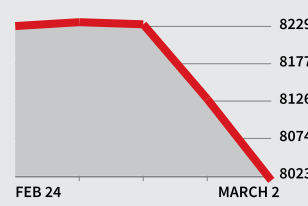
12. The average cost of acquisition of per Equity Shares by the Selling Shareholders, as on date of the Red Herring Prospectus, is as stated below and Offer Price at the upper end of the price band is ₹1,352.
- | Name of the Selling Shareholder | Number of Equity Shares Held | Average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (in ₹) ⁽¹⁾⁽²⁾⁽³⁾ |
|---|------------------------------|--|
| Manish Sharma | 864,000 | 46.00 |
| Ashwini Amit Dixit | 541,500 | 100.00 |
| A91 Emerging Fund II LLP | 8,035,500 | 368.28 |
| NRJN Family Trust (represented by Entrust Family Office Legal and Trusteeship Services Private Limited) | 1,935,000 | 94.86 |
| Xponentia Opportunities Fund - II | 3,478,500 | 352.29 |
| 360 One Special Opportunities Fund - Series 8 | 2,269,500 | 386.31 |
| 360 One Monopolistic Market Intermediaries Fund | 1,575,000 | 386.13 |
| Xponentia Opportunities Limited | 1,417,500 | 352.29 |
| Mace Private Limited | 2,553,000 | 352.29 |
| HDFC Life Insurance Company Limited ⁽³⁾ | 1,419,000 | 373.68 |
| Society for Innovation and Entrepreneurship | 408,000 | 0.01 |
| Cyrus Jamshed Guzder | 132,000 | 340.00 |
| Capri Global Holdings Private Limited | 283,500 | 352.29 |
| SVS Trust No IV | 283,500 | 352.29 |
| Venktesh Investment and Trading Company Private Limited | 211,500 | 352.29 |
| Himanshu Kantilal Sanghavi HUF | 84,000 | 352.29 |
| Devang Mehta | 55,500 | 352.29 |
| Atul Hiralal Shah | 42,000 | 352.29 |
| Bakul Hiralal Shah | 42,000 | 352.29 |
| Devinjit Singh | 22,500 | 352.29 |
| Perumal Ramamurthy Srinivasan | 22,500 | 352.29 |
| Bhavya Kapoor | 15,000 | 352.29 |
| Rahul Bahri | 6,000 | 352.29 |

**As certified by S K Patodia & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants, by way of their certificate dated February 25, 2026*
Notes:
(1) Our Company has allotted 43,569,934 fully paid-up bonus Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each, in the ratio of 1,499:1 (i.e., 1,499 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 for every one Equity Share of face value of ₹10 held) to the eligible shareholders in accordance with the resolution passed by the Board at its meeting held on September 5, 2025, and pursuant to the resolution passed by the Shareholders at an Extraordinary General meeting held on September 10, 2025. The cost of acquisition of Bonus Shares is considered as Nil.
(2) Total consideration paid for allotment of Equity Shares in case of conversion of CCPS has been derived from the consideration paid for the acquisition of CCPS at the time of such acquisition.
(3) HDFC Life Insurance Company Limited is holding equity shares through two demat accounts and accordingly the aggregated shareholding have been reflected here.

Continued on next page...

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 80238.85 (-3055.81)



IN FOCUS

	Week's close	Week's change
Nifty 50	24865.70	-847.30
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	22.03	-0.84
US Dollar (in ₹)	91.47	+0.59
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	166800.00	+9214
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	289848.00	+25773

MIXED TREND.

Rice procurement fell 17% in February, though central pool purchases in October 2025–February 2026 rose 1.9% to 463.06 lt **p8**



STICKY POINTS.

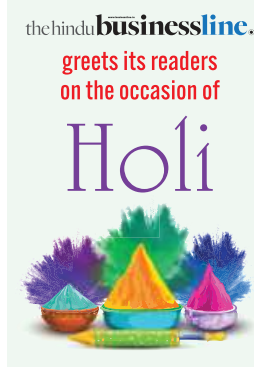
US policy report acknowledges gaps on “sensitive issues” in the US-India bilateral trade deal talks **p7**

QUICKLY.

STRONG FUNDAMENTALS
Mutual funds step up bets on banking stocks



Mumbai: Buoyant fundamentals in the banking sector appear to have prompted mutual funds to increase their exposure to bank stocks over the past year. In the year to December 2025, MFs raised their shareholding by more than one percentage point in AU Small Finance Bank, Axis Bank, Bandhan Bank, Equitas SFB, Bank of Maharashtra, Federal Bank, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, IDFC First Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank, RBL Bank, South Indian Bank, State Bank of India and Ujjivan SFB. **p6**



Iran war: India has 50 days of crude, fuel stocks, says govt

ON WATCH. Control room set up to monitor Strait of Hormuz situation round-the-clock

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government is actively reviewing the conflict scenario in West Asia, top government officials said on Tuesday, adding that India has crude oil stocks for 25 days and an equal volume of refined petroleum products stocks, which is sufficient to address supply disruptions for 50 days. India consumes around 5.6 million barrels of petroleum products, with around 67 million consumers visiting retail outlets every day. Generally, 40 per cent of India's crude oil imports, around 2.6-2.7 mb/d, pass through the Strait of Hormuz. However, in recent years, as domestic refiners increased their procurement from West Asia, including Iraq, Saudi Arabia and the UAE, volumes passing through the world's most strategic energy choke-point have increased to around 50 per cent.

24X7 MONITORING
The Petroleum Ministry said



VITAL CORRIDOR. Nearly 40-50% of India's crude imports pass through the Strait of Hormuz, a key global energy choke point

a 24/7 control room had been set up to continuously monitor the West Asia situation, with input from refiners, shippers and other stakeholders. There are expectations that the situation will “cool somewhat” in the next two weeks. “We have overall around 50 days of stock for oil, which is sufficient. Besides, there is crude in the strategic petroleum reserves (SPRs), which is additional. We can also source from other regions, such as the US, South America and West Africa, which is also happening as we speak.

Refiners are outsourcing replacements as and when needed,” said one of the officials. Responding to a starred question in the Rajya Sabha on February 9, Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri had said that India has around 4.094 million tonnes (mt) of crude stocks in SPRs, which is around 77 per cent of the total capacity of 5.33 mt. At full capacity, SPRs will last for nine-and-a-half days. **NO PRICE HIKE** Government sources said there are no immediate plans

to raise the retail price of petrol and diesel. They also said the general understanding is that if the conflict extends beyond 10-15 days, crude oil prices will surpass \$82 per barrel. Puri said India is “well stocked with crude oil and inventories of key petroleum products, including petrol, diesel and ATF” to deal with short-term disruptions arising from the Middle East.

‘LPG stocks can last 25-30 days’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Top government sources said India has “comfortable” stocks of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) that can last 25-30 days. LPG imports stood at around 20.67 million tonnes (mt) in FY25 and 10.84 mt in H1 FY26. India imports 80-85 per cent of its LPG needs, with the much of it sourced from Gulf suppliers — almost entirely transiting the Strait of Hormuz. **Details p2**

Indian carriers resume limited Gulf services to select destinations

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

India-based airlines on Tuesday commenced special operations to repatriate stranded Indian nationals from West Asia following recent airspace disruptions that led to widespread cancellations and air fare volatility.

The repatriation flights come even as Indian airlines cancelled scores of flights to the West Asian region. On Monday, airlines had cancelled a total of 357 flights.

Apart from the cancellations, industry insiders said that the crisis had led to a rise in international airfares, with ticket prices increasing 10-15 per cent at the lower end for Europe-bound flights and by 30-35 per cent on certain continental US routes, driven by longer alternative routings and supply constraints.

On Tuesday, Air India brought back 149 passengers from Dubai on flight AI916D, which landed in Delhi at 10.58 am.

AI CREW RETURN

Earlier in the day, 143 cockpit and cabin crew members of Air India and Air India Express, who were stranded in Dubai, arrived in Delhi on



ANXIOUS WATCH. Anxious passengers monitoring a screen displaying flight information at Delhi's IGI airport even as the US/Israel-Iran conflict escalated **REUTERS**

board flight AI918D.

The airline said that it would be deploying wide-body aircraft, including Boeing 777 and 787 planes, with higher capacity on its services to Jeddah and Dubai on Tuesday and Wednesday to facilitate the return of passengers who were stuck in West Asia.

SpiceJet operated four special flights on Tuesday from Fujairah to Delhi, Mumbai and Kochi, including two services to Mumbai.

INDIGO OPS FROM WED

The airline will restore its scheduled flights between Fujairah and Delhi and between Fujairah and Mumbai from Wednesday.

IndiGo said that it has begun repatriation efforts in coordination with the authorities and will progressively reinstate select scheduled services from Wednesday.

Operations are expected to resume to Muscat, Jeddah and Madinah, as well as Athens, totalling 13 return flights or 26 sectors.

Air India Express said it will continue to operate scheduled flights to and from Muscat on Wednesday, alongside services to Delhi, Kochi, Kozhikode, Mangaluru, Mumbai and Tiruchirapalli, and will operate additional flights to Delhi, Kochi and Mumbai. **More reports p2, p3**

BHARAT ELECTRICITY SUMMIT 2026
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Conference delegates

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Conference speakers

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Conference sessions



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Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

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Optimal bandwidth

After mispricing spectrum realisation has finally dawned

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India’s proposal to cut the reserve price of spectrum for the upcoming auction by nearly 40 per cent is a tacit admission of the fact that holding on to unsold airwaves actually leads to massive revenue loss. But this realisation comes far too late in a market that has shrunk to just a couple of serious bidders.



The days when spectrum auctions could be designed primarily as revenue-maximising exercises are long gone. Ever since the Centre raked in a windfall during the 3G auction in 2010, spectrum sales have been treated as a fiscal bonanza. Collections of nearly ₹1 lakh crore created the impression that airwaves were a reliable cash cow for the exchequer. Operators fearful of missing out on the 3G wave bid aggressively. Subsequent auctions were then calibrated with the same mindset; reserve prices were kept prohibitively high, often divorced from market realities. The result was predictable. Since 2010, elevated reserve prices recommended by the regulator have led to repeated auction failures, with large chunks of spectrum lying unsold.

The 2016 auction was a case in point. Of the 2,354 MHz of spectrum worth ₹5.63 lakh crore put on the block, bids were received for only 965 MHz, garnering ₹65,789 crore. More than 60 per cent of the spectrum remained unsold. The regulator was blamed for misreading market sentiment while fixing reserve prices. Yet the pattern persisted. In 2024, less than 25 per cent of the offered spectrum was sold, with the Centre achieving only 12 per cent of its revenue target. This is not surprising. Consolidation has reduced the number of major private operators to three. Multiple auctions, spectrum trading and sharing arrangements have ensured that operators already hold substantial airwaves. The incentive to hoard spectrum for future use has diminished, more so at unattractive prices.

High spectrum costs hurt consumers, as it compels operators to raise tariffs or defer network investments. Spectrum is a national resource, but monetising it inefficiently helps neither the exchequer nor citizens. The steep corrections in key bands underscore how inflated past pricing was. In the 900 MHz band, considered among the most efficient for mobile broadband, the reserve price for Delhi circle, for example, has been slashed to ₹327 crore per MHz compared to ₹750 crore per MHz in 2015. The 700 MHz band has seen an even more dramatic reset. In Mumbai, for instance, the reserve price has fallen from ₹1,595 crore per MHz a decade ago to ₹443 crore now, after repeated failures to attract buyers. The opportunity cost of idle spectrum is foregone revenue and delayed connectivity. India must move away from a rigid annual auction calendar towards a dynamic, demand-driven spectrum marketplace. Operators should be able to procure airwaves as needed, with competitive bidding only when multiple entities seek the same block. Such a framework would align India with global best practices.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



AJAI CHOWDHRY

The recent AI Impact summit had some takeaways: The world’s fourth-largest economy — a rising power powered by talent, entrepreneurship and demographic strength, is not going to be an AI spectator. There is a decisive shift to building AI-embraced infrastructure for highways, energy, telecom, and so on. Union IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnav says India expects to attract \$200 billion of AI investments over the next two years.

Why are global AI/tech companies pouring in investments into India? It’s India’s consumer market they are after. Already 100 million ChatGPT users are there, mostly consumers.

For decades, India’s \$300 billion tech services sector, employing nearly six million people, was known primarily for cost arbitrage. The anxiety around AI shrinking tech jobs is overblown. Yann LeCun, godfather of AI and Meta’s former chief AI scientist, has consistently argued that fears of AI causing mass permanent job losses are misplaced and absurd. LeCun views AI as an amplifier of human intelligence rather than a replacement.

The Indian IT industry has endured many disruptions: the dotcom crash of 2000-02 that saw massive project cancellations, pricing pressure and delayed payments; the Global Financial Crisis (2008-09), a recession where clients froze IT spending, renegotiated contracts and currency volatility was the norm; visa and immigration restrictions; and the Covid pandemic — leading to project delays and client uncertainty.

So, historically IT services have faced economic downturns, tech disruptions, political and regulatory pressures, talent and margin pressures. Yet the industry has shown strong resilience by shifting from cost arbitrage to value creation, manpower-based model to now digital and AI led services and IP + AI based revenue.

History suggests technology has enabled new kinds of jobs. The last few decades’ rise of Indian IT services companies was because of multiple new technologies, including the internet, cloud, and mobile. These actually created more jobs even as they led to productivity improvements across industries. When outsourcing reduced enterprise software costs, IT budgets did not contract — they expanded. As prices fell, volumes surged. Why should this time be different?

ChatGPT’s high-voltage debut in 2023 intensified the debate around AI



AI won’t take India’s tech jobs away

NEW OPPORTUNITIES. With GCCs scaling up and IT firms having strong hiring plans, AI will only redefine the kind of jobs that will be in demand

and job loss. Automation has compressed low-value work — repetitive coding, application maintenance, documentation and some BPO tasks that once required large teams.

AI can generate code in seconds, create testing scripts and draft documentation automatically. Boards are asking whether companies can run leaner. Yet, for enterprise-level adoption, and to ensure stable, secure operations, human insight is vital in software testing, coding, and this will ensure that jobs remain intact or even grow, even as there is some displacement in low-end roles.

NEXT LEVEL OF PRODUCTIVITY We are entering a different orbit of productivity. AI writes the first draft of code; engineers focus on refining, contextualising and solving complex domain problems. Value shifts from billable hours to faster, higher-quality

With its talent, scale and adaptability, India is well-positioned not merely to survive the AI revolution, but to lead it

outcomes. India’s IT services firms operate across four major business areas: implementation of large enterprise packages, customised software development, R&D exports, and infrastructure management. R&D services, advanced engineering and complex transformation projects are hard to replace; they may expand. Code generation is only one slice of the enterprise technology lifecycle.

The real complexity lies in integrating new systems into legacy environments, securing them, deploying them at scale and maintaining them over time. Also, the AI tools too for enterprise are different. IT services companies focus on solutions for enterprises and not consumer.

Estimates suggest AI could represent a \$300-400 billion opportunity for IT services companies by 2030 — spanning AI strategy consulting, data preparation, process redesign, legacy modernisation and governance frameworks to ensure AI systems are secure and trustworthy.

If AI were truly hollowing out India’s tech industry, we would see a slowdown in Global Capability Centres (GCCs) setting up here. The opposite is happening. According to IT industry body Nasscom, by the end of 2025, there were more than 1,750 GCCs in India

employing around two million, and their numbers are growing.

Over the past few years, multinational corporations have set up their own GCCs in India — in-sourcing work rather than outsourcing it. Instead of handing projects entirely to service providers, they are building captive technology and R&D centres. IT services firms have adapted by creating GCC partnership models, supporting these centres with specialised expertise, overflow capacity and advanced engineering skills.

Companies such as TCS, Infosys, and Wipro plan to hire 10,000-40,000 graduates this year. Demand is shifting, not vanishing. The real change is in skills. There is no substitute for strong computing fundamentals. Engineers must understand core programming before relying on AI tools.

The real question is not whether AI will take away jobs. It is whether India will move up the value chain fast enough. With its talent, scale and adaptability, India is well-positioned not merely to survive the AI revolution, but to lead it.

The writer is Chairman, EPIC Foundation and MGB (Mission Governing Board), National Quantum Mission. Views are personal

US Supreme Court’s tariff ruling changes little

Trump can theoretically reimpose all the country-specific tariffs by using ‘national security’ and ‘unfair trade practices’ levers

Shang-Jin Wei

The US Supreme Court’s rejection of Donald Trump’s use of the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA) to impose country-specific tariffs has generated an explosion of headlines and rabid denunciations from the president himself. But the ruling’s economic impact on other countries and world trade is likely to be limited.

The IEEPA tariffs were probably already illegal under World Trade Organization rules, as they violated the principle of equal treatment. In any case, Trump has since imposed a new across-the-board 10 per cent tariff under a different law (Section 122 of the Trade Act of 1974), which he is threatening to raise to 15 per cent (the maximum allowed). Such a response is not good news for American households and firms, but it does bring the US closer to compliance with global trading rules.

In the near term, the new surcharge will create winners and losers. Before the IEEPA ruling, trade-weighted effective tariffs were roughly 36.8 per cent on Chinese exports, 22.3 per cent on India, 21.6 per cent on Vietnam, 23.5 per cent on Indonesia, 19.4 per cent on Thailand, 14.9 per cent on Japan, 12.8 per cent on South Korea, 11.6 per cent on Malaysia, and 6.7 per cent on Singapore. But now, with the new 10 per cent Section 122 tariffs, China’s effective rate will fall to about 26.9 per cent, India’s to 13.9 per cent, Vietnam’s

to 16 per cent, Indonesia’s to 16.4 per cent, and Thailand’s to 14.8 per cent, while Japan and South Korea will face modest increases to 13.5 per cent and 12 per cent, respectively.

Similarly, the European Union and the UK will be worse off than before the court’s ruling, because they have made concessions to the US in their bilateral negotiations; but the concession from the US is in fact smaller than the removal of the IEEPA tariffs itself.

Trump’s Trade Representative, Jamieson Greer, declared that the US will reconstruct the country-level tariffs through other means. Perhaps the winners and losers from the Supreme Court ruling are only temporary.

REIMPOSING PREVIOUS TARIFFS The Trump administration has started a process of tapping into Section 232 (on national security) and Section 301 (on unfair trade practices) of the Trade Act of 1974 to restore many elements of the previous tariff landscape. Section 232 allows product-specific tariffs — such as a 25 per cent levy on steel — after a Commerce Department investigation, while Section 301 permits country-specific retaliation following a US Trade Representative inquiry. Because such investigations generally entail a great deal of discretion, Trump could theoretically reimpose all the country-specific tariffs that were in place before the Supreme Court’s ruling.

While China appears to have benefited the most from the Supreme Court decision, the relief will be



COURT RULING. Unlikely to alter US trade barriers significantly REUTERS

temporary. The first Trump administration already used a Section 301 investigation to justify its high tariffs on Chinese imports. The Biden administration concluded in a subsequent review that some of China’s unfair trade practices had persisted and continued the Trump tariffs.

Trump can simply cite the Biden administration’s review as a basis to introduce new tariffs, with rates potentially higher than the IEEPA ones. Though he may refrain from doing so before his visit to Beijing in April, he could make the announcement thereafter.

In principle, other countries can challenge unfair applications of Section 232 and Section 301 tariffs at the WTO, as both the EU and China have done in the past. But these efforts will not get very far, because the WTO Appellate Body has been inoperative since 2019, owing to America’s refusal to allow new judicial appointments. Indeed, a WTO

panel ruled in 2020 that the first Trump administration’s 301 tariffs on China were not justified; but since the Appellate Body was not functioning, no final ruling could be issued.

The US has two additional advantages over other countries: its ability to “weaponize commerce” and its ability to “commercialize weapons.” The US government can leverage its position as the world’s largest importing market to extract concessions from others, and it can leverage allies’ security dependencies to “induce” them into investment and trade concessions.

Trump’s willingness to use both levers will make other governments think twice before taking the US to the WTO. For Japan, South Korea, and parts of Europe, security considerations would likely outweigh the benefits of litigation. The legal availability of a WTO dispute-settlement process is one thing; the political willingness to use it is quite another.

In the end, the Supreme Court’s ruling on Trump’s tariffs may modify the legal facade of US trade policy, as well as produce a brief surge of imports into the US. But it is unlikely to reduce the overall height — or significantly alter the country composition — of US trade barriers.

The writer, a former chief economist at the Asian Development Bank, is Professor of Finance and Economics at Columbia Business School and Columbia University’s School of International and Public Affairs. Copyright: Project Syndicate, 2026. www.project-syndicate.org

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Wages for domestic help

This refers to ‘Reforming domestic work’ (March 3). The Supreme Court is right in refusing to entertain a PIL seeking minimum wages for domestic workers, as there is so much subjectivity involved in it. But it cannot be denied that domestic workers are being exploited at every nook and corner of the country. The Goa experience is a good pragmatic approach where families don’t face the hassle of finding a good domestic worker and domestic workers are also getting paid well. The same model can be replicated in

other cities where different companies can set up their base and cater to residences within a certain geographical limit.
Bal Govind
Noida

Urban expansion

Apropos ‘Easing key bottlenecks in cities’ (March 3), incessantly expanding cities are no longer arenas of opportunity. Despite public expenditure, outcomes remain perversely disproportionate, diluted by fragmented planning, politicised

procurement, and systemic corruption. Policy favours visible mega-projects over resilient neighbourhood systems, spectacle over sustainability, and electoral optics over evidence. Mobility collapses, green buffers disappear, and public services fracture along social fault lines. The deepest loss is institutional credibility. Citizens no longer expect reform; they merely endure dysfunction. Governance becomes performative and hollow. Unless these basic obstacles are eliminated, urban

liveability stagnates for citizens.

N Sadhasiva Reddy

Bengaluru

Revised GDP series

Apropos ‘Strong base’ (March 3). The revised GDP series is a step in the right direction. Shifting the base year to 2022-23 and incorporating GST data, employment surveys, and high-frequency indicators brings our national accounts closer to economic reality. The uptick to 7.6 per cent real growth is encouraging, though the puzzle of a smaller nominal GDP despite richer data

sources deserves a clear official explanation. If new datasets genuinely capture more economic activity, the nominal size should logically be larger, not smaller. The government would do well to publish a detailed reconciliation note so analysts and policymakers can work with full confidence. Good statistics are not merely technical achievements — they underpin every serious policy decision. India’s credibility rests on transparency, not just methodology.

M Barathi

Bengaluru

QUICKLY.

Infosys, Intel announce AI partnership expansion



Bengaluru: Infosys and Intel have announced the next phase of their collaboration to help enterprises move from AI pilots to production at scale. The expanded collaboration brings together Intel's high-performance, compute platforms and Infosys' Topaz Fabric. **OUR BUREAU**

India probes Chinese PVC resin imports

New Delhi: India has initiated a countervailing duty investigation against imports of Chinese PVC resins, used in multiple sectors including pipes, bottles and cables, following complaints by domestic players that China is subsidising its PVC Suspension Resin makers. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies (DGTR) investigation follows an application filed by Chemplast Cuddalore Vinyls, DCM Shriram and DCW. **ETI**

STATE OF THE ECONOMY

One way India can strengthen its economy is by sustaining growth at 7-8 per cent to close the post-COVID gap, says Yuvika Singhal, Economist, QuantEco

<https://tinyurl.com/mpvbnw4y>

Also available on Spotify, Apple Podcasts and Google Podcasts

Mutual funds take a shine to bank stocks

ROBUST PERFORMANCE. Nifty Bank Index has appreciated 24 per cent over a one-year period

Suresh P Iyengar
K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

The banking sector's robust health, signified by credit growth, improving asset quality, stable profitability and stake buys by foreign banks and institutions in private sector banks, has prompted mutual funds to increase their weightage in the sector, leading to significant rise in their stakes in various banks over the last one year.

Some of the banks in which MFs have increased their shareholding by more than 1 per cent between December 2024 and December 2025 include AU Small Finance Bank (SFB), Axis Bank, Bandhan Bank, Bank of Maharashtra, Federal Bank, HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank, according to data from primeinfobase.com.

“Overall, the banking system is doing very well with non-performing assets at

multi-decade lows and improving credit growth. The RBI's Financial Stability Report highlights revival in credit demand. Some sectors like MSMEs, retail and segments of the corporate sector are borrowing more, “ said VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist, Geojit Investments.

“This impressive credit growth along with better asset quality is expected to result in impressive profit numbers. Tier-2 banks reported better Q3 results, and this trend is expected to continue,” he said.

BANK STOCKS SIZZLE
The robust fundamentals of the banking sector is reflected in the performance of the bank stocks with the Nifty Bank Index appreciating 24 per cent over a one-year period. “Considering the sustained financial performance of banks, their stock valuations are very attractive. MFs participated in the qualified institutional place-

MF shareholding in banks		
Bank	MF stake as of Dec-end 2025 %	Percentage points change over Dec-end 2024
AU Small Finance Bank	22.61	5.50
Axis Bank	32.39	4.80
Bandhan Bank	11.79	3.55
Bank of Maharashtra	5.32	4.47
Equitas SFB	45.20	7.70
Federal Bank	37.78	3.25
HDFC Bank	23.09	2.38
ICICI Bank	26.09	2.08
IDFC FIRST Bank	10.93	6.37
Kotak Mahindra Bank	21.18	3.74
RBL Bank	34.44	22.00
South Indian Bank	11.90	8.11
State Bank of India	13.64	1.41
Ujjivan SFB	23.82	19.99
YES Bank	3.58	2.84

Source: primeinfobase.com

ments of some banks. Funds are also re-directing their investments from IT stocks to bank stocks,” said Mangesh Kulkarni, Head-Portfolio Management Services, Almondz Financial Services.

The substantial increase in MFs' stake in Equitas SFB and Ujjivan SFB comes in the wake of AU SFB receiving the RBI's in-principle approval in August 2025 to convert

into a universal bank. MFs' stake in AU SFB has gone up 5.5 percentage points/pp since December-end 2024 to 22.61 per cent as of December-end 2025. MFs' stake in Equitas SFB amd Ujjivan SFB rose 7.7 pp (to 45.2 per cent as of December-end 2025) and 19.99 pp (to 23.82 per cent), respectively.

The 22 pp jump in MFs' stake (to 34.44 per cent) in

RBL Bank comes in the backdrop of Emirates NBD Bank's decision to acquire controlling stake in the former through a primary infusion of about \$3 billion (₹26,850 crore). MFs upped their stake in IDFC First Bank, up 6.37 pp to 10.93 per cent, and Federal Bank (up 2.25 pp to 37.78 per cent).

During the current fiscal, the arms of Warburg Pincus and ADIA acquired about 9.45 per cent (for ₹4,876 crore) and 5 per cent (₹2,624 crore), respectively, in IDFC First Bank. One of Blackstone's funds has invested ₹6,196.5 crore in the warrants of Federal Bank, translating into a shareholding of 9.89 per cent.

Among public sector banks, MFs have preferred Bank of Maharashtra, upping their stake by 4.47 pp to 5.32 per cent. SBI is the only other PSU bank in which MFs have increased their shareholding by more than 1 per cent (up 1.41 pp to 13.64 per cent).

Bearish sentiments take a toll on SME IPOs

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The bearish sentiments in the capital market have taken a toll not only on main-board initial public offerings (IPOs) but also on the SME exchanges with about 69 per cent of issuances trading below their IPO price. Of the total 32 SME IPO issuances in 2026 so far, 22 are trading at 3-72 per cent discounts to their issue price, while the remaining have managed to close above their issue price.

On Monday, two companies listed on the BSE SME Exchange and one on NSE Emerge. Of them, Mobilise App Lab (NSE Emerge) and

Kiassa Retail (BSE SME) were down 16 per cent and 8 per cent below their issue price, while Accord Trans-formers closed 14 per cent above issue price on the BSE SME.

Similarly on the main-board, one in two IPOs listed are trading below the IPO price with only 10 companies venturing out to tap the capital markets so far this year.

SECONDARY MARKET
Though the pipeline of companies waiting to hit the mainboard market remains strong, the current fluid situation in the secondary market, due to the ongoing war between Israel and Iran, may delay some of the issuances.



Thomas Stephen, Director and Head-Preferred at Anand Rathi Shares and Stock Brokers, said it has been a rather tepid response for IPOs issuances this year with only 32 companies listed compared to over 50 in the year-ago period. A good chunk of these recent IPOs

were of large companies, which are trading at issue price or lower due to heightened market volatility.

Large IPOs are no longer considered a “safe bet” by investors, who are now more aware of the company's valuations, he said. While investors' appetite for IPOs still remains strong in terms of wealth generation, they will be more selective and will run better due diligence before investing, said Stephen.

Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer, Master Capital Services, said many large IPOs are trading below their issue price because they were priced very aggressively at the time of listing,

but once the stock starts trading in the secondary market, investors shift their focus from “story and hype” to actual earnings performance and cash flows.

When the recently-listed companies start trading below their issue price, it makes investors more cautious and hesitant to subscribe to future IPOs, he added.

“Companies planning to launch an IPO need to keep more realistic valuations that aligned with current market conditions and register steady earnings growth besides strong financial performance and transparent disclosures to gain investor trust,” said Singh.

TODAY'S PICK.

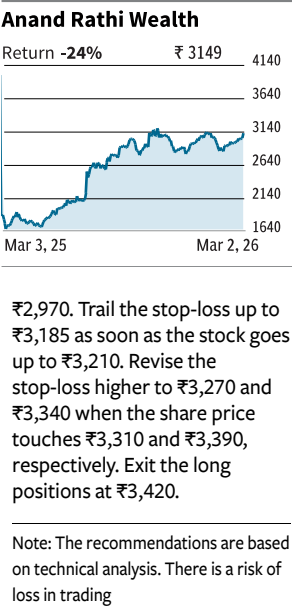
Anand Rathi Wealth (₹3,149.45): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Anand Rathi Wealth. The stock rose by over a per cent on Monday, when the broader markets were beaten down.

The stock has strong support in the ₹3,030-3,000 region. This support can limit downside if the stock declines below ₹3,100. A possible moving average crossover on the daily chart also strengthens the bullish case. Anand Rathi Wealth share price can rise to ₹3,400-3,450 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Anand Rathi Wealth shares now at ₹3,149 per share. Accumulate on dips at ₹3,085. Keep the stop-loss at



Day trading guide

24988 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24865	24750	25025	25160	Take fresh shorts only below 24865 with a stop-loss at 24910	
₹880 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
874	870	890	898	Wait for a rise. Go short at 888 with a stop-loss at 892	
₹1288 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1270	1245	1300	1315	Go short only below 1270. Keep the stop-loss at 1280	
₹315 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
311	309	318	322	Go short now and at 317. Stop-loss can be kept at 319	
₹281 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
279	277	284	289	Take fresh longs above 284. Keep the stop-loss at 282	
₹1360 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1340	1300	1380	1400	Go short only below 1340. Keep the stop-loss at 1345	
₹1189 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1175	1155	1205	1230	Wait for dips. Go long at 1180 with a stop-loss at 1170	
₹2612 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2580	2550	2640	2685	Go short on a break below 2580. Keep the stop-loss at 2590	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Risk-off sentiment, due to West Asian crisis, drags rupee

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The rupee weakened over the last week, as global and domestic factors turned adverse.

WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.

The escalation of tensions involving the US, Israel and Iran has sharply shifted the global risk sentiment, triggering a risk-off move across markets. A key concern is the potential disruption of oil supplies through the Strait of Hormuz, through which nearly 20 per cent of the world's crude oil passes. Brent crude futures (now at \$82/barrel) have risen about 14 per cent so far this month

and are up about 33 per cent year-to-date. Given India's dependence on oil imports, sustained strength in crude prices increases dollar demand and exerts pressure on the rupee. The dollar has also strengthened amid safe-haven flows, adding to the headwinds for emerging market currencies. The dollar index, currently at 99, is up 2.3 per cent over the last three weeks.

Domestic indicators have not offered support either. Industrial production growth slowed to 4.8 per cent in January 2026 from 7.8 per cent in the previous month. Additionally, net foreign outflows totalled about \$810 million in the last two sessions, reflecting heightened investor caution.



Overall, the fundamental backdrop remains unfavourable for the rupee. That said, the RBI may step in to limit excessive volatility if pressures intensify.

CHART

The rupee slipped below the 91 support level on Monday, indicating that the bears are

regaining traction. On Monday, it closed at 91.48, and on Tuesday, the market remained closed due to Holi.

The offshore market suggests the rupee is likely to open Wednesday's session with a considerable gap down, possibly even below 92. Given the risk-off sentiment, we can expect further decline in the local currency. Potential support below 92 is at 92.25 and 92.50. If the local currency recovers, it will face resistance at 91.50 and 91. Given the prevailing price action and market sentiment, the rupee moving above 91.50 is unlikely.

The dollar index has been capitalising on the current developments.

It broke out of a trendline resistance at 98.70. It is

SEBI's overlap rule may trigger ₹76,000 crore MF portfolio reshuffle

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Mutual fund houses may need to reshuffle portfolios worth about ₹76,000 crore as they move to comply with SEBI's new rules aimed at curbing excessive overlap between schemes.

According to an analysis by Elara Securities, about 51 sectoral and thematic schemes currently have over 50 per cent portfolio overlap with another equity scheme within the same asset management company. The comparison included overlaps with both other thematic funds and diversified equity schemes, excluding large-cap funds.

However, the number of cases that may see meaningful portfolio changes is far smaller. Excluding funds with assets below ₹1,000 crore, only 13 schemes show an overlap exceeding 52 per cent, the report said. About ₹76,000 crore of assets may require portfolio reallocation, the brokerage estimated.

COMPLIANCE WINDOW

The regulator has provided a staggered implementation timeline for fund houses to comply with the rule. Around 35 per cent of the overlapping exposure will need to be adjusted in the first year, another 35 per cent in the second year and the remaining in the third year.

“In the context of overall market liquidity and considering that the adjustment is spread over three years, the aggregate impact does not appear materially disruptive,” Elara said.

In fact, the brokerage estimates that the actual selling requirement could be far lower. If fund houses proportionately trim positions in the smaller scheme of each



overlapping pair, cumulative selling could amount to about ₹6,135 crore.

Under a more optimised approach, where adjustments are made across schemes to minimise trades, the selling requirement may fall slightly to about ₹5,890 crore.

LARGE-CAPS IN FOCUS

The highest overlapping exposures are largely concentrated in highly-liquid large-cap stocks such as banks, telecom and index heavyweights, which are seen as capable of absorbing the flows.

Among the scheme pairs with the highest overlap are Quant Momentum Fund and Quant Quantamental Fund with a 78 per cent overlap, Motilal Oswal Business Cycle Fund and Motilal Oswal Multi Cap Fund with 75 per cent and Aditya Birla Sun Life Business Cycle Fund and Aditya Birla Sun Life Flexi Cap Fund with 63 per cent. Elara said portfolio realignment is more likely to occur within the smaller scheme of each pair, since adjusting the larger fund would have a greater execution impact.

Beyond the immediate selling pressure, the more relevant effect could be a gradual shift in portfolio construction. Funds may create room for alternative holdings and reduce concentration in overlapping stocks, as they reposition portfolios to meet the new regulatory threshold.

Japan in talks to explore rare earth deposits in India

Reuters
New Delhi

Japan is in talks with India to jointly explore rare earth deposits in Rajasthan, two people familiar with the discussions said, as Tokyo seeks to reduce reliance on China for supplies critical to magnet manufacturing.

Last month, Union Mining Minister G Kishan Reddy said three hard rock rare earth deposits, containing 1.29 million tonnes of rare earth oxides, had been identified in Rajasthan and Gujarat. Tokyo has expressed interest in the Rajasthan deposits and plans to send experts to the site, said the sources.

‘Integrating Gift City, Mumbai could make India a regional finance powerhouse’

bl.interview

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Michael Syn, President of SGX Group (Singapore Exchange), sees a historic moment unfolding in India's financial markets.

With Gift City emerging as an international-first hub and Mumbai operating as a highly-liquid domestic powerhouse, he believes that carefully integrating the two centres could create a market of unprecedented scale, liquidity and international connectivity — one capable of attracting global capital and serving a vast arc extending from eastern and northern Africa, the Gulf to the Indian subcontinent.

Edited excerpts:

How is India positioned in the global context when it comes to attracting international capital?

India has a clear, long-term advantage. Today, India's market is split into two complementary pieces — the highly-liquid domestic market, and Gift City, which is an international-first, unified-

regulator hub and highly interoperable with global markets. If, over time, these two centres are brought closer together, the combined liquidity and international connectivity can become a very powerful locus of attention for global capital.

The next stage of development is to leverage this market power to create a wider sphere of influence. The opportunity now is to think beyond domestic strength and shape a broader regional and global role for its capital markets. We have been one of the earliest and most enthusiastic participants in India's growth story. We launched the SGX Nifty 50 bank in 2000 — so what looks like an “overnight success” is actually 26 years old.

Why do you believe India stands to benefit in a world that is becoming more fragmented?

If you look at the arc covering East and North Africa, Turkey, the Gulf and the Indian subcontinent, this is one of the most exciting zones in terms of demographics and economic growth in the new world order. Yet, it does not have a dominant financial centre

Gift Connect launched with \$10 billion in open interest, and three years later, it has grown to \$20 billion

MICHAEL SYN
President, SGX Group



serving its needs in a comprehensive way.

Take commodities as an example. Much of the world's crude oil comes from this region, yet benchmark pricing still happens in London on Brent or in the US on WTI and liquidity remains fragmented. India has the regulatory depth, market experience and scale to address this broader opportunity.

How has the migration of SGX Nifty to Gift Nifty impacted international participation and liquidity?

Leading up to the launch, international participants weren't used to something as complex as this. They'd seen stock connects before — Shanghai, Hong Kong — but a derivatives connect with Gift City was much

more advanced. There has only been one similar model in the world: the Chicago-Singapore “mutual offset” connect, which was launched in 1984 in the era of open outcry before electronic trading. That 24-hour link between Singapore and Chicago ultimately won the global interest rate derivatives market. We applied that playbook carefully with Gift Connect, working closely with NSE, IFSC authorities and the Indian government.

Gift Connect launched with \$10 billion in open interest, and three years later, it has grown to \$20 billion.

There's a perception that 70-80 per cent of Gift Nifty volumes come from Singapore. How should we interpret this?

The purpose of Gift City is to

bring international investments into India — it's a gateway. Naturally, initial participation comes from Singapore through SGX, but if you look at the Indian market in Mumbai, its volume is about a thousand times bigger. So today's numbers are just a temporary staging point.

The focus shouldn't be on where the current volume comes from, but on how to increase investor participation from both sides. Gift's design is deliberately open — no fortress, no veil — providing a controlled interface between domestic and international markets. As regulations and mechanisms evolve, Indian liquidity can start participating more actively in Gift, creating a much larger, bilateral market. That's the ambition and the long-term mission for International Financial Services Centre.

How can Gift Nifty evolve to meet international investors' growing needs?

With 320 IPOs in India last year, international investors now need access to individual companies, not just the Nifty 50. That's why a stock connect is becoming

very important. By linking international investors with domestic markets, the stock connect would immediately expand the investment pool, making the ecosystem far more integrated and efficient. This is the next frontier of growth for Gift and a natural evolution of its role as India's international financial gateway.

Today, the Gift Connect is still in the very early stages — it's just one way. But not only should customers come in, when they come in, they will also want to trade out. This is what will make Gift City and the Gift Connect very powerful. I hope that happens soon.

What is the current revenue split between SGX and Gift, and how close are we to reaching parity?

Near-term milestones were clearly about successfully keeping volumes stable, and we have comfortably exceeded that now.

The focus is on gradually expanding participation from brokers and customers before thinking about new products. International participants aren't asking for more products right now — they want more customers to interact with.

CM
YK

QUICKLY.

Power Min extends NEP feedback deadline

New Delhi: The Ministry of Power has extended the timeline seeking stakeholders' comments on the Draft National Electricity Policy (NEP) 2026 by one month till March 19. The timeline has been extended on the request of several stakeholders who have sought additional time to examine the provisions of the draft electricity policy, the Ministry said in a notification dated February 25. The NEP 2026 aims to address high losses and debt of discoms, non-cost-reflective tariffs and high cross-subsidisation. [pn](#)

Govt sets up panel to select NTPC chief

New Delhi: The Power Ministry has decided to set up a search-cum-selection committee to look for the head of the State-owned electricity generator NTPC, as the government headhunter Public Enterprise Selection Board (PESB) failed to identify a suitable candidate. Candidates can apply for the post on or before March 28, 2026, it said. [pn](#)

MoD inks ₹5,083 crore contract for 6 advanced light helicopters, missiles

ADDING MUSCLE. Deals were also signed for buying surface-to-air Shtil missiles and fuel barges

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Defence on Tuesday signed contracts worth a total of ₹5,083 crore for the acquisition of six advanced light helicopters (ALH) Mk-III (maritime role) for the Coast Guard and surface-to-air vertical launch Shtil missiles for the Navy.

Besides that, another contract for the construction of four 500-tonne self-propelled fuel barges was concluded with Shoft Shipyard Pvt Ltd, Thane, for refuelling ships and submarines.

The contract for ALH Mk-III (MR), along with operational role equipment, an engineering support package and performance-based logistics support, valued at ₹2,901 crore, was inked with the Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) under the buy (Indian-indigenously designed developed and manufactured) category, the MoD



ENHANCED SECURITY. These twin-engine helicopters incorporate state-of-the-art features and are capable of undertaking a wide spectrum of maritime security missions [pn](#)

said in a statement.

These twin-engine helicopters incorporate state-of-the-art features superior to the currently operated airborne platforms and are capable of undertaking a wide spectrum of maritime security missions from shore-based airfields as well as from ships at sea.

The induction will significantly enhance the Coast

Guard's capability for fulfilling the duties of safety and protection of artificial islands, offshore installations, and protection of fishermen and marine environment.

The project envisages supply of equipment from more than 200 MSMEs and is expected to generate approximately 65 lakh man-hours of employment, reinforcing the government's commitment

to 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat'.

'SHTIL MISSILES'

The contract for the procurement of the surface-to-air vertical launch Shtil missiles and associated missile holding frames, valued at ₹2,182 crore, has been signed with JSC Rosoboronexport, Russia. The acquisition is intended to substantially enhance the air defence capabilities of

frontline warships against a wide spectrum of aerial threats.

The system will reinforce the layered air defence architecture onboard the platforms of the Navy by providing rapid-reaction, all-weather engagement capability and improved survivability in contested maritime environments, as per the Ministry. The contract further underscores the long-standing and time-tested defence partnership between India and Russia, founded on mutual trust and strategic alignment.

The primary role of the barges will be replenishment of fuel to ships and submarines in harbour and at anchorage. With this contract, the Navy continues to encourage and bolster the growth of MSME shipyards, thereby contributing immensely towards the domestic shipbuilding ecosystem in line with the 'Maritime India Vision 2030'.

GST registrations rose by over 5 lakh since November

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

With the process eased, the monthly average number of GST registrations is over 1.25 lakh between November and February, data from the GST portal showed. While Uttar Pradesh continued to lead in the number of registrations, Maharashtra recorded the maximum addition in the four-month period.

According to the GST portal, the total GST identification numbers as of October 31, 2025, which was over 1.56 crore, rose to over 1.61 crore on February 28, 2026, showing an increase of over 5.16 lakh. Based on the GST Council recommendations, a simplified GST registration

scheme was made effective for small and low-risk businesses from November 1, 2025. At the time of introduction, it was said that the new scheme would benefit around 96 per cent of applicants for GST registration.

The GST Council unveiled a New Rule 14A for a quick 3-day registration wherein SMEs can get registrations in maximum three days with only basic documentation and on a straight through process.

While this comes with certain restrictions like a threshold limit of ₹2.5 lakh per month of ITC which can be passed on, it still helps SMEs.

KEY FACTORS

Experts also attribute the ex-

GST taxpayer base

Total GST Identification Number (Central and State formation combined)			
	As on October 31, 2025	As on February 28, 2026	Change
Pan India	1,56,64,457	1,61,80,832	5,16,375
Key States			
Uttar Pradesh	20,58,744	21,37,377	78,633
Maharashtra	19,03,125	19,83,096	82,971
Gujarat	13,25,324	13,82,342	57,018
Tamil Nadu	11,96,041	12,29,088	33,047
Karnataka	10,76,523	10,98,897	22,374

Source: GST Portal

pansion of the tax base to small and medium businesses increasingly joining the GST fold. "The surge in new taxpayers under the GST framework reflects the growing confidence in India's simplified tax ecosystem. The introduction of Aadhaar authentication has expedited and streamlined

GST registration process, allowing applicants to receive registration numbers much faster. Further, the adoption of e-invoicing, along with its seamless integration into the e-way bill system, has reduced administrative burden and made compliance processes more efficient for businesses," Smita Singh,

Partner (Indirect Tax) at S&A Law Offices, said.

"This is the key reason why GST registrations have shot up during this period. In case one breaks up the figure of total registrations from November 2025 to February 2026 between Rule 14A and normal registrations, one would certainly witness a skewed curve towards Rule 14A ones," said Vivek Jalan, Partner at Tax Connect.

Another reason could be strong import momentum. According to Sivakumar Ramjee, Executive Director-Indirect Tax with Nangia Global, in February 2026, import-related IGST collections increased by 17.2 per cent compared to February 2025, while cumulative growth stood at 13.8 per

cent. "Increased import activity typically brings more importers, distributors, logistics operators and intermediaries into the GST framework, contributing to a broader registration base," he added.

Saurabh Agarwal, Tax Partner at EY India highlighted that a simplified registration framework for suppliers operating through electronic commerce operators has lowered the entry barriers for micro-entrepreneurs and gig workers.

"Together with GST rate rationalisation aimed at widening the tax base, these measures have strengthened compliance, expanded the taxpayer universe and reinforced revenue stability," he said.

StartupTN, TNWESafe launch entrepreneurship bootcamp for women

Our Bureau
Chennai

StartupTN, Tamil Nadu Government's nodal agency for start-ups and the Tamil Nadu Women Employment and Safety (TNWESafe) project, a government initiative for women empowerment, have jointly launched EmpowHer 1.0.

The two-day bootcamp trained a cohort of 160 women entrepreneurs from Chennai and nearby towns to provide them with the mentorship required to

transform ideas into structured business action. EmpowHer 1.0 included multiple workshops and seminars.

MOU SIGNED

During the event, a Memorandum of Understanding was signed for the establishment of a Campus Circle at Ethiraj College for Women in Chennai.

The bootcamp was launched by Asha Ajith, Project Director, TNWESafe, in the presence of Sivarajah Ramanathan, MD & CEO, StartupTN and industry leaders.

Over 40 lakh beneficiaries in TN get special cash assistance

Our Bureau
Chennai

As Tamil Nadu gears up for Assembly Polls, around 40 lakh beneficiaries in the State, comprising old-age pensioners, widows, differently-abled persons and fishermen, were credited with cash assistance ranging from ₹3,200 to ₹8,000 on Tuesday.

Chief Minister MK Stalin announced that the special summer assistance of ₹2,000 that was earlier provided to women under the Kalaigarnar Magalir Urimai Thittam has been extended to the elderly, widows, elderly transgenders



Chief Minister MK Stalin

and persons with disabilities.

"Accordingly, to a total of 29.29 lakh beneficiaries —including the elderly and widows benefiting under various social security schemes—we have provided ₹3,200 each; to 5.92 lakh persons with disabilities, ₹3,500 each; and to the families of 2.58 lakh per-

sons with disabilities receiving caregiver assistance, ₹4,000 each, this morning," he said in a social media post on X.

In addition ₹8,000 per family has also been provided to a total of 1.62 lakh fisherfolk families as part of the fishing ban assistance for April-June. Similarly, for the benefit of 14,870 tea farmers from the Nilgiris district, ₹8.53 crore has been provided as a base price of ₹2 per kg for green tea procured through 15 co-operative tea factories.

"We will leave no one behind in Tamil Nadu's journey of growth," he declared.

ESR Group buys 85 acres in Hosur for ₹250 crore

Our Bureau
Chennai

Sambhav Homes & Infrastructure, a Bengaluru-based real estate firm, has transferred an 85-acre fully developed land parcel in Hosur through a special purpose vehicle (SPV) to the Singapore-headquartered ESR Group, marking its foray into Tamil Nadu's industrial and warehousing segment.

The company formed an SPV for the Hosur property and transferred it to ESR for a consideration of ₹250 crore, said Sanjai Kumar,

Defence Acquisition Board clears ₹1 lakh cr buy of 60 medium transport planes

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

More than three years after the Indian Air Force (IAF) issued a Request For Information (RFI) seeking replacement of its ageing transport fleet, the Defence Acquisition Board, headed by Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, has cleared the acquisition of 60 medium transport aircraft (MTA), expected to cost around ₹1 lakh crore.

Now, the MTA programme for which there are two bidders — Embraer offering C-390-Millennium, and Lockheed Martin the C-130, which the Indian Air Force is already using — will have to be cleared by the Defence Acquisition Council, headed by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, before formal negotiations begin for buying the transport aircraft.

Top Ministry sources confirmed to *businessline* that the DAB gave the nod for 60 MTA that the IAF has been seeking for long to replace its ageing Russian origin An-32 and IL-76 aircraft.

PAYLOAD CRITERIA

Per the RFI issued on December 9, 2022, the IAF is seeking transporters in the 18-30 tonne payload class.

The category specification rules out Airbus, whose A400M Atlas has the max-

imum capacity of 37 tonnes. Both the C-390-Millennium and the C-130 fall in the 18-30 tonne class. The government is looking to acquire a certain number of aircraft in ready-to-fly condition and have the remaining manufactured locally, with about 50 per cent indigenous content, people aware of the development said.

This positioning aligns with the Centre's negotiations with France to manufacture 90 of the 114 Rafale fighter aircraft in India.

The remaining 24 jets, if the deal materialises, will be delivered in flyaway condition as per the IAF's specifications.

The IAF already operates 12 Lockheed Martin C-130J Super Hercules aircraft, widely used for special operations, troop transport, and humanitarian relief missions.

Brazilian aerospace major Embraer and the Mahindra Group announced plans to partner in setting up maintenance, repair and overhaul (MRO) facilities in India for the C-390 Millennium, subject to the aircraft's selection under the MTA programme.

TATA-LOCKHEED TIE-UP Similarly, Lockheed Martin and Tata Advanced Systems Ltd have announced plans to set up an MRO facility to support C-130J Super Hercules aircraft.

Telangana meets record 18,139 MW peak demand

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Telangana State power utilities successfully met a record peak electricity demand of 18,139 MW on Tuesday morning, marking the highest peak demand ever recorded, according to Deputy Chief Minister Bhatti Vikramarka Mallu.

"This milestone reflects Telangana's economic growth, operational effi-

ciency and excellent coordination," he said in a statement.

With a peak demand of 18,139 MW, Telangana was comparable to larger States such as Madhya Pradesh, which recorded around 19,900 MW, and Rajasthan, which registered peak demand between 19,600-20,600 MW. The State recorded higher peak demand than industrial States such as Punjab, Haryana, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh.

'Escorts Kubota set to become a pan-Indian player'

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Escorts Kubota is on track to become a pan-Indian company with special focus on Southern markets, according to its CMD Nikhil Nanda. "We have a growing ambition to become a pan-Indian company," Nanda said while announcing the launch of 'Shourya', a new 'South special' tractor series, priced in the ₹5.75-7.3 lakh range (ex-showroom), here on Tuesday. The launch was in line with the objectives of the company as part of measures to deepen its presence in paddy markets and expand its regional footprint, Nanda said.

After shut airspaces, soaring anxiety... home at last

Returnees recall blasts, fear and long waits and local govts' prompt assistance

Press Trust of India

Relief and anxiety marked the return of passengers stranded in the Gulf as the conflict escalated, disrupting air travel and daily life across West Asia.

Sunil Gupta, who landed in Delhi from Dubai, said, "I didn't feel any relief, not even during the flight until I finally landed in Delhi."

"I was very worried. I have never faced such a situation before. Even on the flight, I kept thinking about what was happening. All I wanted was to return home and be with my family," he said.

CANCELLED FLIGHTS

As tensions spiked with Iran responding to the US-Israel strikes, airspace over much of the region was closed, leading to widespread flight cancellations.

Arvind, a Noida resident returning from Dubai, said many travellers were stranded after the sudden cancellations.



BACK SAFE. Passengers from Dubai arriving in Delhi after flights resumed from several affected countries [SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA](#)

"People had gone for a few days and were not prepared for extra expenses. That is the biggest problem," he said, adding that he stayed four additional days and witnessed missile interceptions in the sky.

For some families, the crisis was more personal. Kunwar Shakeel Ahmed said his daughter, an Indian student in Iran, had reported blasts near her hostel.

Passengers arriving in Chennai and Bengaluru recounted similar experiences. Shubha, transiting through Dubai from New

York, said airspace closure stranded her in a hotel and she could hear explosions every few hours. "Today, we are happy to be back home, safe and alive," she said.

Others described deserted roads, crying children at airports and long queues as nearly 20,000 passengers were accommodated in hotels. Another passenger Syed Ali said, "Upon hearing the news, several children started to cry due to the situation at the Dubai airport. However, the hotel authorities helped us a lot and accommodated us."

CENTRE, STATES HELP

"Nearly 20,000 people were seen standing in long queues and were sent to various hotels. We should thank both the Central and State governments for taking steps for our safe return," said Ali, who hails from Nagoor in Tamil Nadu.

In Bengaluru, travellers from Abu Dhabi spoke of missile alerts and interceptions visible from the hotel. Many praised airlines and the UAE authorities for providing accommodation and transport, and thanked the Indian government for co-ordination.

In Mumbai, Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde arranged two flights from Fujairah to bring back 164 stranded residents, including 84 students. The State, in co-ordination with the Indian People's Forum in Dubai, opened a WhatsApp helpline (+971 50 365 4357) for stranded citizens requiring assistance.

Tata Motors, Mahindra & Mahindra clarify on Indonesia orders; say there is no material impact

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra in back-to-back regulatory filings have countered media reports that Indonesia had suspended vehicle imports from them.

The clarifications followed exchange queries and share price volatility triggered by a March 2 report.

Both companies confirmed that they had not received any official notice of suspension, and there had been no significant impact on their businesses.

Together, they are set to supply 1,05,000 vehicles to Agrcinas Pangan Nusantara as part of Indonesia's Koperasi Desa/Kelurahan Merah Putih project, which is a State-backed initiative focused on rural mobility.

CONTRACT SECURED

Tata Motors referenced its disclosure from February 10, in which its subsidiary, PT Tata Motors Distribusi In-



NOT AFFECTED. Tata Motors and M&M clarified that they had not received any official notice on suspension of orders

onesia, secured a contract for 70,000 vehicles.

The company dismissed the media reports, stating, "The articles in Indonesia (reproduced in India) reflect a domestic policy discussion on imports and local manufacturing, rather than any demand or execution related to the order we received."

They stressed that "the order and the advance payment we have received are programme-driven," with plans to start supplies soon and deliver in phases. "The published article has no material impact on the company."

Mahindra & Mahindra highlighted its announcement from February 4 of a record 35,000 units export order for Scorpio Pik Up light commercial vehicles.

The company confirmed that it had received an advance payment and added, "To date, we have not received any further communication from Indonesia regarding the suspension of the order."

EXPERT CLAIM

Despite both OEMs asserting that "all is well," a senior industry analyst who spoke to *businessline* said that the situ-

ation highlights the risks for Indian OEMs pursuing scale in politically sensitive markets. Large deals tied to government programmes often clash with host countries' push for localisation and domestic production.

"Competitors like China's BYD have already established a foothold through factories; Indian companies must consider similar investments," the analyst stated, emphasising that while export success brings contracts, a sustainable presence requires adaptation.

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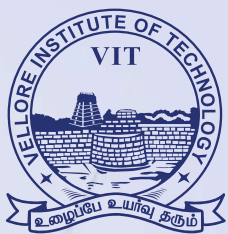
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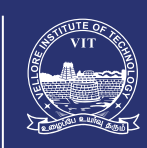


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